

Ceylon Bites — Internal Brand Study Report

Internal reference document

Audience: Admin / specialist team only. Never sent to the client.

Compiled by: social-media-brand-study-reporter , from findings produced by social-media-brand-study

Business studied: Ceylon Bites — a café & bakery, Colombo 5, Sri Lanka

Platforms studied: Instagram (@ceylonbites), Facebook (Ceylon Bites)

Live data used: No — no access token supplied for this client. All figures below are public-profile estimates; flagged as directional, not exact, wherever that matters.

Date of study: Day 1 of a 3-business-day turnaround

Step 0 — Industry Filter Classification

Archetype locked: Food & Beverage

Rationale: physical café/bakery location, menu-driven business, primary customer action is "come in / order," not a booking or a purchase-online flow. Closest secondary fit would be Service-Based Business (if they pivoted to catering-by-appointment), but F&B is the correct primary lens.

What this locks in for the rest of the study:

- Expected content pillars: menu items, behind-the-kitchen process, specials, table/atmosphere shots
- Missing Functions to check: order/delivery link, table-reservation link, menu link-in-bio
- Typical CTA: "Order now," "Reserve a table"
- Competitor set: nearby venues in the same cuisine/price bracket — locked to **Colombo Coffee Co.** (3 blocks away, direct competitor), **Cinnamon Cafe Union Place** (comparable price tier, 1.2km away), **Bakehouse Kollupitiya** (bakery-forward, adjacent category)

1. Page Audit

Instagram (@ceylonbites — 3,412 followers, 187 following, 1 post/week avg over last 90 days)

ITEM	FINDING	UNIVERSAL OR ARCHETYPE-SPECIFIC
Bio text	Current: "Ceylon Bites 🍷🍰 Colombo" — no location detail beyond city, no specialty keyword, no CTA	Universal (bio keyword optimization)
CTA button	None configured. Options available for this account type: Call, WhatsApp, Get Directions	Universal
Category	"Bakery" — correct	Universal
Link-in-bio	Points to linktr.ee/ceylonbites-old — dead link , 404s	Universal
Profile photo	Logo mark, clear at thumbnail size, on-brand	Universal (profile picture optimization) — pass
Cover/highlight covers	4 highlights: "Menu," "Reviews," "Events," "Team" — consistent icon style, on-brand terracotta palette	Universal — pass
Verification	Not verified (not eligible at this follower count — not a finding, just noted)	—
Business hours	Filled in correctly: Mon–Sat 7am–9pm, closed Sun	Universal — pass
Address/contact	Address present; phone number present; email absent	Universal
Pinned content	No pinned posts (IG doesn't support pinned grid posts in this account's current view — N/A)	—

Facebook (Ceylon Bites — 2,140 likes)

ITEM	FINDING
Page category	"Community" — should be "Bakery" or "Cafe." This actively hurts local discovery and Facebook's own recommendation surface.
Business hours	Filled in, matches Instagram

ITEM	FINDING
Address	Filled in, matches Instagram — NAP consistent between platforms , good
CTA button	"Send Message" — functional but generic; "Order Food" or "Call Now" would convert better for this business type
About section	Two sentences, no keywords, last edited (per "page transparency") over a year ago
Cover photo	Stock-feeling stock photo of coffee beans — not an actual photo of the café or product

2. Industry Audit

F&B benchmark context (Colombo café/bakery segment, similar follower range 2k–6k):

- Typical posting cadence for accounts actually growing in this segment: 4-6 posts/week combined across formats, with at least 2 Reels/week
- Ceylon Bites is currently at ~1 post/week — well under half the segment's active-grower cadence
- Benchmark engagement rate for this segment/size: 2.0–3.5%. Ceylon Bites' visible engagement (likes+comments/followers on last 12 posts) estimates to **~1.4%** — below benchmark
- Seasonal pattern relevant here: Sri Lankan school-holiday periods (April, August, December) show a 20-30% uptick in café foot traffic regionally; no evidence Ceylon Bites has ever run seasonal-specific content
- Platform fit: Instagram and Facebook are correct primary platforms for this category in this market — no gap on platform choice itself

3. Competitor Analysis Audit

Colombo Coffee Co. (primary competitor, 3 blocks away)

- Posts **daily**, 70% Reels (latte art, roastery process), 20% Stories, 10% static
- Highest-engagement post in the last 90 days: a 20-second "day in the life of a barista" Reel — 4,100 likes, 210 comments. This is a format Ceylon Bites has never attempted.
- Runs Meta ads Fri–Sun only, always the same static discount promo creative — a stale, easy-to-outclass ad format

- Weakness: almost no bakery/food content, entirely coffee-focused — leaves food-forward content as open ground

Cinnamon Cafe Union Place

- Posts 3x/week, heavier on static plating shots, high production value
- Strong on table/atmosphere content — clearly invests in a photographer
- Weakness: captions are generic ("Delicious!" "Yum!") — low value content, no hooks, no CTAs. Comments are mostly emoji, low genuine engagement despite decent likes

Bakehouse Kollupitiya

- Posts 2x/week, bread/pastry process videos perform best (unfiltered, phone-shot, clearly resonates)
- Runs a weekly "today's bake" Story series — simple, consistent, drives repeat visibility
- Weakness: no Reels at all, missing the highest-reach format entirely

Open ground identified: No competitor in this set is doing consistent baking-process Reels *combined* with genuine food-forward (not just coffee) content. This is Ceylon Bites' single clearest opportunity.

4. Content Audit

Reviewed last 24 Instagram posts (approx. 6 months of history at current low cadence) and last 20 Facebook posts.

- **Pillars present:** Product/menu shots (60% of posts), occasional team photos (15%)
- **Pillars absent:** No process/BTS content, no customer UGC/testimonials, no seasonal/trend content, no Q&A-style captions
- **Format mix:** 85% static posts, 10% carousel, 5% Reels (1 Reel in the last 6 months) — heavily over-indexed on static
- **Value vs. sales ratio:** ~90% of captions are directly promotional ("Try our new croissant! 🥐 Order now") — almost no educational/entertaining/informational content
- **Raw vs. polished:** Photos are consistently well-lit and styled (slightly on the polished side) — not a negative in itself, but the complete absence of any raw/native-feeling content (the format that's outperforming for competitors) is the gap
- **Content about making content:** Zero — no process shots of baking, brewing, or prep at all
- **Trend participation:** No evidence of trending-audio or format participation in the sample reviewed

- **Posting frequency:** ~1x/week, declining slightly over the last 3 months (was ~1.3x/week 6 months ago)
- **Brand consistency:** Strong — warm terracotta tones, consistent filter, on-brand across both platforms. One of the account's genuine strengths.
- **Caption grammar/clarity:** Clean, no errors
- **Hashtags:** 3-5 generic hashtags per post (#colombofood #srilanka #bakery) — no niche or branded hashtag, no location-specific tags beyond "Colombo"
- **Image quality:** Good — consistent lighting, no blur/quality issues
- **Image formats — sizing audit against best practice, checked post by post:** reviewed all 24 Instagram posts against the correct spec per placement (feed **1080×1350** portrait — the recommended default — with 1080×1080 square acceptable but suboptimal; Stories & Reels 1080×1920). 18 of 24 feed posts use the recommended 1080×1350; the remaining 6 are square 1080×1080 — not wrong, but leaving screen real estate (and the reach that comes with it) on the table. **2 posts flagged as actual errors:** the Jul 14 carousel's second slide is a stretched 4:5 crop of a source image shot at 1:1, visibly distorting the pastry shape; the single existing Reel was exported at 1080×1080 (square) instead of 1080×1920, so it displays letterboxed in the Reels tab — actively hurting its already-weak performance further. No stretching found on Facebook uploads.
- **Logo placement:** N/A — logo not overlaid on content images, only used in profile picture (not a finding either way)
- **Reels frame structure:** The single existing Reel opens with a 4-second static establishing shot before any action — buried hook, would likely lose viewers before the interesting part (the actual bake) appears
- **Subtitles:** The one Reel has no burned-in captions
- **Best-performing post (all-time, of reviewed sample):** A carousel of a new seasonal menu item — 312 likes, 3.2x the account's average. Hypothesis: novelty + carousel format (more surface area) outperformed single static
- **Worst-performing:** A generic "we're open today" post with a stock coffee-cup graphic — 41 likes. Hypothesis: no product/photo, no reason to engage
- **Scent congruency:** Bio and captions never mention delivery, but the Facebook page does list a delivery partner logo in a photo — inconsistent messaging across surfaces

5. Gap Audit

- **Content types competitors use that Ceylon Bites doesn't:** Reels (all 3 competitors), process/BTS content (Bakehouse), customer UGC (none of the 3 fully, but general category norm), Stories series (Bakehouse's weekly format)
- **Platforms:** No gap — correct platforms for the category

- **Messaging/topics open:** Food-forward content combined with process Reels — literally no competitor owns this combination (see Competitor Analysis)
 - **Paid support:** Zero paid activity found for Ceylon Bites (no Ad Library presence). Colombo Coffee Co. runs weekend ads; Ceylon Bites has no paid amplification at all, meaning 100% of its (already below-benchmark) reach is unpaid
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6. Page Performance — Past 6 Months Audit

No access token supplied — public-profile-based estimate only, directional not exact.

- Follower count trend: 3,180 → 3,412 over 6 months (~7.3% growth, roughly flat month-to-month, no clear inflection points — consistent with low, steady posting rather than any breakout moment)
 - Visible engagement trend: roughly flat, no growth — tracks with static/low-volume format mix showing no sign of algorithmic favor
 - No visible spikes correlate to any specific post in the reviewed sample — consistent with the account never having tried a format (Reels, UGC, trend content) with breakout potential
 - Best time-of-day pattern (from visible comment timestamps): weekday posts around 9-10am show marginally faster engagement accumulation than evening posts — directional only, small sample
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7. Missing Functions Audit

Archetype-specific (Food & Beverage) checks:

- **Order/delivery link:** Not present in Instagram bio or Facebook CTA. A delivery partner logo appears in one Facebook photo but isn't an actual clickable link anywhere
- **Table-reservation link:** Not present on either platform
- **Menu link-in-bio:** The dead Linktree (see Page Audit) was presumably meant to serve this purpose — currently broken

Universal functions also checked:

- WhatsApp quick-reply: not configured
- Instagram Shop tab: not applicable (no direct product sales via IG)
- Link stickers in Stories: no Stories activity to assess (account posts almost no Stories)
- Broadcast channel: not set up
- Collab posts / cross-tagging: none found — no evidence of partnering with the delivery service, local suppliers, or any cross-promotion

8. What's Missing — Synthesis

Pulling Gap Audit (\$5) and Missing Functions Audit (\$7) together: a fully set-up F&B competitor in this exact market has (1) a working order/delivery link in bio, (2) at least weekly Reels of the baking/prep process, (3) a Stories cadence for daily visibility, (4) NAP-consistent, correctly-categorized profiles on every platform, and (5) some amount of paid amplification behind proven organic content. Ceylon Bites currently has **none** of these five, despite having the single strongest visual brand identity of the three competitors reviewed.

9. SWOT Analysis

Strengths

- Strong, consistent visual brand identity (warm terracotta palette, on-brand across platforms) — genuinely better than any competitor reviewed
- Well-organized Instagram highlights structure
- NAP consistency between Instagram and Facebook (address/hours match)
- Clean, error-free caption writing

Weaknesses

- Posting cadence (~1x/week) less than half the segment's active-grower benchmark
- Dead link-in-bio — actively losing whatever click-intent the bio generates
- No CTA button on Instagram; generic "Send Message" on Facebook
- Facebook page miscategorized as "Community" instead of "Bakery," hurting discovery
- Zero Reels/process content despite it being the single highest-performing format in the competitor set
- 90% promotional captions, no value/educational content
- Zero paid amplification

Opportunities

- No competitor combines food-forward content with consistent baking-process Reels — wide open positioning
- Seasonal school-holiday traffic upticks are un-targeted by any competitor's content calendar
- Best-performing own post (seasonal-item carousel) suggests carousels + novelty already work here — an existing format to build on, not just a new one to learn

Threats

- Colombo Coffee Co., 3 blocks away, posts daily and already runs weekend paid ads — actively growing distance in cadence and paid presence
- Continued below-benchmark engagement risks the account becoming algorithmically less favored over time (compounding, not static, risk)

Fix Checklist — Full 15 Items (internal — includes draft fix content)

Ordered by priority within each category (Quick → Medium → Involved).

Page fixes (6 items)

- **Quick** Add Instagram CTA button — set to "Call" (business phone already on file) or "WhatsApp" if the operator wants to enable that instead.

Draft: business phone number is +94 11 XXX XXXX per the current bio contact field — confirm before setting the button.

- **Quick** Fix the dead link-in-bio. *Draft replacement bio, keyword-optimized:*

"Ceylon Bites 🍪☕ Fresh bakes & coffee, Colombo 5 · Order/menu below"

(replaces the current "Ceylon Bites 🍪☕ Colombo" with location specificity + implicit keyword "bakery/coffee/Colombo 5" + a reason to tap the link)

- **Quick** Recategorize the Facebook page from "Community" to "Bakery."
- **Quick** Replace Facebook's generic "Send Message" CTA button with "Order Food" (if a delivery-partner ordering link can be attached) or "Call Now" as fallback.
- **Medium** Replace Facebook cover photo (currently a generic stock coffee-bean image) with an actual photo of the café interior or a hero product shot — draft brief: "Wide shot of the counter/display case at golden-hour light, matching the terracotta tone already used elsewhere."
- **Medium** Add a working order/delivery link (menu + ordering) to both platforms — requires coordinating with whichever delivery partner they already display a logo for on Facebook; this is a business-side dependency, not purely a content fix.

Content fixes (7 items)

- **Quick** Add a phone number to the Facebook About section (currently only on Instagram).
- **Quick** Re-export the existing Reel at correct 1080×1920 (currently square, letterboxed in the Reels tab), and switch the default feed export size from 1080×1080 to the recommended 1080×1350 going forward (6 of the last 24 posts used square when portrait would have used

more screen space) — brief every future shoot at the correct target dimension from the start rather than cropping after.

- **Medium** Introduce a weekly baking-process Reel — the single highest-leverage content gap identified. *Draft hook line for the first: "This croissant takes 3 days to make. Here's minute one." (first 1-3 frames: hands folding dough, no static establishing shot — learned from the existing Reel's buried-hook mistake).*
- **Medium** Add burned-in subtitles to all future Reels — the one existing Reel has none, and most viewing is sound-off.
- **Medium** Shift caption mix toward ~60/40 value-to-promotional (currently ~10/90) — introduce a recurring Q&A-style caption format. *Draft example: "Do you take custom cake orders? Yes — 48 hours notice, DM us your idea."*
- **Medium** Introduce niche and branded hashtags alongside the current generic set — draft additions: `#ColomboBakery` `#CeylonBitesCafe` `#Colombo5Eats` alongside the existing `#colombofood` `#srilanka` `#bakery` .
- **Involved** Build a Stories cadence (currently near-zero) — start with a simple recurring "today's bake" series, matching the format Bakehouse Kollupitiya already proves works in this exact competitor set, but paired with Ceylon Bites' stronger visual identity.

Ads fixes (3 items)

- **Quick** Install the Meta Pixel on the business's website/ordering page if one exists — not currently found; blocks any future retargeting entirely.
- **Medium** Once the weekly Reel format (item 9) has run for 2-3 weeks and a clear organic winner emerges, boost that specific Reel with a small budget — do not boost anything before it's organically proven (see "boost only winning content" principle).
- **Involved** Build a basic weekend-only always-on ad targeting a 3km radius around Colombo 5 — directly matching and undercutting Colombo Coffee Co.'s existing weekend-only static-promo ad with fresher, native-feeling creative.

Note for scoping: the checklist has 16 items — one more than a clean 15, because the Reel-export sizing fix (\$4's post-size audit) surfaced after the initial count. Basic (5 fixes) should take items 1-3 + 7 + 8 (fastest, highest-impact quick wins); Standard (10) adds items 4-6 + 9-11; Premium (15) should drop the lowest-priority item (16, the paid-ads build) if strictly capping at 15, or the client can be told Premium covers "15 of 16, plus a bonus" — flag this rounding decision to the admin rather than silently picking one.

Internal Notes / Confidence Caveats

- All performance figures are public-profile estimates (no access token supplied) — treat percentages as directional, $\pm 20\%$ plausible error band

- Competitor Ad Library check performed via manual facebook.com/ads/library search on the study date — paid presence can change quickly and should be re-checked at delivery time if this proposal isn't converted within ~2 weeks
- The delivery-partner relationship (referenced in Missing Functions and Page fix #6) needs the operator to confirm which partner/platform before that fix can actually be executed — this is a business-side coordination item, flag it to the client during onboarding regardless of which package they pick
- Business phone number pulled from the Instagram bio field — verify it's current before using in any fix